

Skills Summary

Shape Names — Turning Does Not Change Them

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

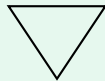
Skill 1 — Count the sides to name it

Count the straight sides. The number tells you the name.

- 3 straight sides = **triangle**
- 4 straight sides, all the same length = **square**
- 4 straight sides, two long and two short = **rectangle**
- 6 straight sides = **hexagon**
- no straight sides, one curved edge = **circle**

It does not matter which way the shape is turned. Touch each side as you count.

Example: What is this shape called?



Step 1. It is upside down, so do not go by how it looks — count the straight sides instead, because that is what the name is made of.

Step 2. Touch the top edge, then the right edge, then the left edge: that is one, two, three straight sides.

⇒ **3** sides, so it is a **triangle**

Try it: How many straight sides does this shape have?



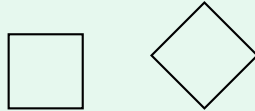
check: 6 sides, a hexagon

Skill 2 — Turning changes nothing

Turn a shape and nothing countable changes. Same number of sides, same number of corners, same name.

A square balanced on its corner is still a **square**. “Diamond” says which way it is turned; it does not say what the shape is.

Example: Count the corners on each. Is one bigger than the other?

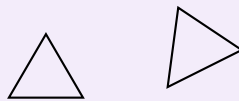


Step 1. These are the same square, and one of them has been turned — so instead of guessing, count the corners on each one and compare the two numbers.

Step 2. Flat one: one, two, three, four corners. Turned one: one, two, three, four corners.

⇒ $4 = 4$, so both are squares

Try it: Count the corners on each triangle and compare them.



check: $3 = 3$, both are triangles

Skill 3 — Sort, count, then compare

Sort first, then count, then compare. Name every shape in the group before you count, so a turned shape lands in the right pile.

Then put the two numbers side by side: $>$ means the first is bigger, $<$ means the second is bigger, $=$ means they are the same.

Example: Which group has more shapes?

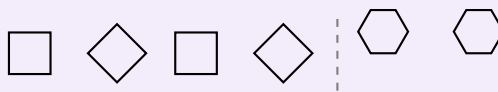


Step 1. Count each group on its own before comparing anything, because the eye is easily fooled when one group’s shapes are bigger than the other’s.

Step 2. Left group: three circles. Right group: five triangles, some of them turned.

⇒ $3 < 5$, so the right group has more

Try it: Which group has more shapes?



check: $4 > 2$, the left group has more